

WinAPI Calculator

A scientific calculator with both **GUI** and **CLI** versions, built using pure Win32 API without MFC dependencies. Supports various number formats, binary operations with configurable width, advanced mathematical functions, complex numbers, matrices (up to 7×7), user-defined functions, and loading custom constants from a file.

This calculator project on WinAPI (VS2022) is based on my old project on Cbuilder VCL (BCB6) [fcalc](#), which, in turn, is based on DOS programs and [Ccalc](#) sources that have been heavily reworked since then.

```
//-< CCALC.CPP >-----*-----*
// Ccalc                      Version 1.02      (c) 1998  GARRET  *   ?   *
// (C expression command line calculator)        *  /\|  *
//                                              *  /  \  *
//                      Created:    20-Oct-98    K.A. Knizhnik * / [] \ *
//                      Last update: 20-Oct-98    K.A. Knizhnik * GARRET *
//-----*-----*
```

Important note.

The DLL version is only available for 64-bit systems and is compiled using 128-bit floating-point numbers (IEEE 754-2008 quadruple precision (binary128)). This format is used only for actual calculations; input data is processed as 64-bit (IEEE 754), and output is processed only in forced float mode and with the selected precision prec(34) (default: 16 digits).

Version	Type (bit)	Exponent (bit)	Mantissa (bit)	Precision (digits)	Range (approximately)
std	Double (64)	11	52	15..17	±2.2E-308 .. ±1.8E+308
bcb	Long Double (80)	15	64	18..19	±3.4E-4932 .. ±1.1E+4932
dll	Quad (128)	15	112 (+1)	33..36	±3.4E-4932 .. ±1.2E+4932

Since number input is processed as double, it's not possible to directly enter a number outside the double range, even in the 80- or 128-bit versions. However, you can enter 1.234×10^{1234} .

Two Versions Available

Features

GUI Version (WinApiCalc)

- **Scientific Calculator:** Support for trigonometric functions, logarithms, exponentials, and more
- **Expression Parser:** Advanced mathematical expression evaluation with proper operator precedence
- **History Dropdown:** Keep track of previous calculations with easy access through dropdown menu (auto-saves on exit)
- **DPI Awareness:** Automatic scaling for high-DPI displays
- **CHM Help Support:** F1 help integration for external help files
- **Standard Windows Interface:** Native menus, keyboard shortcuts, and clipboard integration
- **Multiple Output Formats:** Display results in decimal, hexadecimal, octal, binary, scientific notation, etc.
- **Configurable Binary Width:** Choose binary display width from 8 to 64 bits
- **Variables Dialog:** View and manage calculation variables
- **Customizable Options:** Case sensitivity, forced float mode, ESC minimization, opacity control
- **Implicit Multiplication:** Optionally omit multiplication operator in common cases
- **User-Defined Functions:** Define and nest custom functions (up to 10 levels deep)
- **Custom Constants File:** Load user-defined constants and functions from `consts.txt` and `user.txt`
- **Matrix Support:** Full matrix arithmetic up to 7×7 , including inverse, determinant, transpose
- **Numerical Methods:** Equation solving (`solve`), integration (`integr`), differentiation (`diff`), summation (`sum`)

CLI Version (ccalc)

- **Command-line interface:** Perfect for scripts and automation
- **Same calculation engine:** Identical mathematical capabilities as GUI version
- **Multiple output formats:** Supports all format options via command-line flags
- **Configuration file support:** Load default options from `ccalc.cfg`
- **Batch processing:** Process expressions from scripts or command line
- **Built-in help system:** Access help via `ccalc "help(n)"` command

CLI Usage

Basic calculations (always use quotes!)

```
ccalc "2+2"
```

```
ccalc "sqrt(3^2+4^2)"
```

```
ccalc "sin(pi/4)"
```

With options

```
ccalc "0xFF + 0b1010" /HEX+ /BIN+
```

```
ccalc "2k5" /SCI+ # 2500 with scientific notation
```

```
ccalc "2+3i" /NRM+ # Complex numbers
```

```
ccalc "2+3i" /CPX+ # Complex numbers in polar form
```

Show help

```
ccalc "help(0)" # Overview
```

```
ccalc "help(1)" # Functions
```

```
ccalc "help(4)" # Constants (including physical constants)
```

```
ccalc "help(7)" # Options
```

Configuration file (ccalc.cfg)

Place in same directory as ccalc.exe

```
/SCI+ /IMUL+ /BW=64
```

Batch Processing (File or Stdin)

Process a file of expressions line by line, redirecting output to a file:

```
ccalc /ALL-/AUTO+/SRC+/FILE="apicalc_cli_tests.txt" >result.txt
```

Or via stdin pipe:

```
type apicalc_cli_tests.txt | ccalc /ALL-/AUTO+/SRC+ >result.txt
```

With /SRC+ each output line includes the source expression:

```
-1^2 ;; -(1^2), not (-1)^2 => -1
```

```
integr(exp(-(x^2)), -5, 5, x) ;; sqrt(pi) => 1.77245385090552
```

Without /SRC+ only results are printed, one per line:

```
-1
```

```
1.77245385090552
```

Lines starting with ;; are comments and produce no output. Blank lines are passed through as blank lines.

The CLI version allows to specify options in the expression comment that determine the output format when the /AUTO+ option is enabled, which determines the output format based on the input format. For example

```
L:=130u;;Inductance /ALL-/FLT+ => 0.00013
5`42'38";;;/ALL-/DEG+ => 0.099668 rad|5`42'38" (5.71056`)|6.345 gon|0.01586 turn
2sin(15`42'38"");;/ALL-/ENG+ => 541.6m
```

;Output Format Options:

/DEG+	;Degrees format
/ENG+	;Engineering (Scientific) numbers format (6k8 => 6800)
/STR+	;String format
/HEX+	;Hex format
/OCT+	;Octal format
/BIN+	;Binary format
/DAT+	;Date time format
/CHR+	;Char format
/WCH+	;WChar format
/CMP+	;Computing format
/UTM+	;Unix time format
/NRM+	;Normalized output
/IGR+	;Integer output
/UNS+	;Unsigned output
/FRC+	;Fraction output
/FRI+	;Fraction inch output
/FRH+	;Temperature
/FLT+	;Floating point output
/UTM+	;Unix time
/ALL+	;All of the above

IMPORTANT: Always use quotes around expressions! Symbols like ^, |, &, <, > have special meaning in PowerShell/CMD.

Supported Functions

Basic Operations

- Addition +, Subtraction -, Multiplication *, Division /
- Modulo %, Power ^
- Percentage % and %%
- Parentheses for grouping
- ; to separate expressions

Note: Unary minus has lower priority than power: $-1^2 = -(1^2) = -1$, not $(-1)^2 = 1$.
Use parentheses when needed: $(-1)^2 = 1$.

Percentage Operations

The % operator in $x \text{ op } y\%$ computes $y\%$ as a percentage **of the left operand** x , then applies the operation:

$$x \text{ op } y\% \rightarrow x \text{ op } (x * y / 100)$$

This matches the behaviour of most pocket calculators:

$72 - 20\%$	$\rightarrow 57.6$	$(72 - 72*0.20 = 72*0.80)$
$200 + 10\%$	$\rightarrow 220$	$(200 + 200*0.10)$
$100 * 10\%$	$\rightarrow 1000$	$(100 * 100*0.10 = 100*10)$
$500 * 5\%$	$\rightarrow 12500$	$(500 * 500*0.05 = 500*25)$
$1 / 2\%$	$\rightarrow 50$	$(1 / 1*0.02 = 1/0.02)$

Chained percentage operations use the result of the previous operation as the new base:

$$72 - 20\% + 5\% \rightarrow 60.48 \quad (57.6 + 57.6*0.05)$$

The %% operator is the **reverse percentage**: how many percent is x relative to y as a change from y :

$$x \% \% y \rightarrow (x / y - 1) * 100$$

$$57.6 \% \% 72 \rightarrow -20 \quad (57.6 \text{ is } 20\% \text{ less than } 72)$$

Mathematical Functions

- **Trigonometric:** sin, cos, tan, asin, acos, atan
- **Hyperbolic:** sinh, cosh, tanh
- **Logarithmic:** ln, log (natural log), lg, log10 (base 10)
- **Other:** sqrt, exp, abs, floor, ceil, round

Utility Functions

- **pol**: Convert to polar coordinates
- **const("name", value)**: Define a named constant programmatically
- **var("name", value)**: Define a named variable programmatically
- **wrgb, trgb**: Color-related utility functions
- **winf**: Returns a string describing the portion of the spectrum of a given wavelength
- **frh(x)**: Convert Fahrenheit to Celsius (e.g., `frh(75)` → 23.89°C)
- **bind(x), binf(x)**: Reinterpret a floating-point value as an integer by its raw bit pattern (the inverse of `floatd/floatf`). Useful for inspecting IEEE 754 representation:

```
bind(pi)    → 400921fb54442d18h    ;; double (64-bit) bit pattern of π
binf(pi)    → 40490fdbh            ;; float (32-bit) bit pattern of π
```

- **floatd(x), floatf(x)**: Reinterpret an integer as a floating-point value by its raw bit pattern (the inverse of `bind/binf`):

```
floatd(0x400921FB54442D18) → 3.14159265358979    ;; reconstruct π from bits
floatf(0x40490FDB)         → 3.141593            ;; 32-bit float precision
floatd(bind(pi))           → 3.14159265358979    ;; round-trip
```

- **cmplx / cpx / cplx(a, b)**: Construct a complex number (all three are synonyms)
- **prn("format", ...)**: Formatted print, e.g., `prn("f:%SHz, Rw:%S0hm", f, Rw)`
- **polar(m, a)**: Construct a complex number from magnitude and angle in radians, or in degrees using the degrees`minutes`seconds" format:

```
polar(10, 30`)      → |10|(30`0'0") 8.660254+4.999999i
polar(10k, 30`20'40") → |10k|(30`20'40") 8.63k+5.052ki
```

This function is built-in (previously defined in `consts.txt`).

- **solve(expr, var:=estimate)**: Find root (also complex) of equation `expr(var)=0` using Newton-Raphson method. The last variable in the initial conditions is the one being solved for:

```
solve(x*(2x+2)-2, x:=0)    → 0.6180339887500326
solve(x*(2x+2)-2, x:=-1)  → -1.61803398875005
solve(z^2+z+1, z:=0+1i)   → |1|(120`0'0") -0.4999999999999997+0.866025403784438
5i
```

Can be used as an operand in complex expressions: `sqrt(solve(...))`.

- **calc(expr, var:=val):** Evaluate expression for a given variable value — useful for selecting initial approximation for solve:

```
calc(x*(2x+2)-2, x:=-1) → -2
calc(z^2+z+1, z:=0+1i) → |1|(90`0'0") 0+1i
```

- **integr(expr, from, to, var):** Numerical integration using adaptive Gauss-Kronrod G7/K15 method:

$$\int_{-5}^5 e^{-x^2} dx = \sqrt{\pi} \approx 1.7725$$

```
integr(exp(-(x^2)), -5, 5, x) → 1.772453850902790 ;; sqrt(pi)
integral(exp(-(x^2)), -5, 5, x) → 1.772453850902790 ;; sqrt(pi)

integr(sin(x)/x, 0.001, pi, x) → 1.850937052038021
```

Can be used as operand: sqrt(integr(sin(x)^2, 0, 2*pi, x)).

- **diff(expr, point, var):** Numerical differentiation using central difference method:

```
diff(sin(x), pi/4, x) → 0.7071... ;; cos(pi/4)
```

- **sum(expr, from, to, var):** Summation over integer range. Supports both ascending and descending order:

```
sum(1/x!, 0, 10, x) → 2.718281525573192 ;; partial sum of e
sum(1/x!, 20, 0, x)-e → 0 ;; reverse order = exact result
```

Complex Number Support

- All mathematical operations and functions (including trigonometric, hyperbolic, exponential, logarithmic, power, and square root) support complex arguments and return complex results where appropriate.
- Functions like `sqrt`, `log`, `ln`, `asin`, `acos`, `pow` and operator `^` automatically switch to the complex version when the real result is undefined — for example `sqrt(-1)` returns `|1|(90°0")0+1i`` instead of NaN.
- Complex numbers can be entered in the form `a+bi` or `a+ib` (e.g., `1+2i`, `1+i2`, `3-4i`).
- Functions like `sin`, `cos`, `exp`, `abs`, etc., work with both real and complex arguments.
- The result is displayed in the form `a+bi` if the imaginary part is nonzero.
- The `~` operator on a complex number returns its **complex conjugate** (negates the imaginary part). On integers, `~` performs bitwise NOT.
- When the result is complex, it is displayed in **both rectangular and polar forms** for convenience:

`~(1+2j) → |2.236068|(-63°-26'-5") 1-2j`

Polar form notation: `|modulus|(degrees`minutes'seconds")`

User-Defined Functions

User-defined functions can be specified inline or loaded from `consts.txt`:

```
{frq(L, C) 1/(2*pi*sqrt(L*C))}
```

Then use them in expressions:

```
frq(130u, 2n2) # Result: 297602.87 Hz
```

Key properties:

- Functions can be nested up to **10 levels** deep.
- When a user-defined function is called, all previously defined constants (including those from `consts.txt`) are available inside it, but not variables.
- User-defined functions can be **overridden** by re-declaring them (previously, re-declarations were silently ignored).
- Type checking is enforced on function arguments — for example, you cannot call `sin` on a string.

Comments

Use the `;;` operator for inline comments:

```
2+2 ;; This is a comment
```


Matrix Support

Matrices up to 7×7 are supported. Matrix syntax:

```
[(a11, a12, ...); (a21, a22, ...); ...]
```

Each row is enclosed in (), rows are separated by ;, the whole matrix is enclosed in []. Elements can be plain numbers (SI suffixes supported) or expressions using previously defined constants and variables, as long as the result is a real number or integer. Complex numbers, strings, or matrices cannot be matrix elements. Variables declared inside the matrix are local to it and not accessible afterwards:

```
[(-1k, 2m, 3M); (4, 5u, 6n); (7p, 8G, 9)]  
[(a:=2*pi, a/3); (b:=e, b/2)] → [(6.283, 2.094); (2.718, 1.359)]
```

When the result is a matrix, it is displayed in engineering format, one row per line:

```
[(      1,      2,      3);  
 (      4,      5,      6);  
 (      7,      8,      9)]
```

Elements that are negligibly small compared to the matrix norm (Frobenius) are displayed as zero to suppress numerical noise.

Matrix Operations

Binary operators (where M = matrix, s = scalar):

Expression	Result	Notes
M + M	matrix	element-wise, dimensions must match
M - M	matrix	element-wise
M * M	matrix	true matrix multiplication
M + s, s + M	matrix	scalar added to each element
M - s, s - M	matrix	
M * s, s * M	matrix	scalar multiplication
M / s	matrix	divide each element by scalar
s / M	matrix	divide scalar by each element
M ^ n	matrix	integer power n≥0, square matrix only
M == M, M != M	0 or 1	all elements equal?
M // s, M // M	matrix	parallel resistors, element-wise

Unary operators:

Expression	Result	Notes
-M	matrix	negate all elements
~M	matrix	transpose (rows ↔ columns)
!M	matrix	matrix inverse (square matrix only)

Matrix Functions

Function	Returns	Notes
tr(M)	scalar	trace — sum of diagonal elements
det(M)	scalar	determinant, square matrix only
norm(M)	scalar	Frobenius norm $\sqrt{\sum a_{ij}^2}$
abs(M)	matrix	element-wise absolute value
dot(A, B)	scalar	dot product of two vectors (1×N or N×1), any length
cross(A, B)	vector	cross product of two 3-element vectors (1×3 or 3×1)
rows(M)	scalar	Return rows of matrix
cols(M)	scalar	Return columns of matrix
size(M)	scalar	Return rows*columns of matrix

Matrix Examples

```
A := [(1,2,3);(4,5,6);(7,8,9)]
D := [(1,2);(3,4)]
```

```
A + 2      → [(3,4,5);(6,7,8);(9,10,11)]
A * 2      → [(2,4,6);(8,10,12);(14,16,18)]
~A         → [(1,4,7);(2,5,8);(3,6,9)]      ;; transpose
D^2        → [(7,10);(15,22)]
!D         → [(-2,1);(1.5,-0.5)]            ;; inverse
D * !D     → [(1,0);(0,1)]                  ;; identity
tr(A)      → 15
det(D)     → -2
norm(D)    → 5.477225575051661
```

;; vectors (row or column):

```
dot([(1,2,3)], [(4,5,6)])      → 32
dot([(3,4)], [(3,4)])          → 25      ;; = norm^2
cross([(1,0,0)], [(0,1,0)])    → [(0,0,1)]
cross([(1,2,3)], [(4,-1,2)])   → [(7,10,-9)]
dot(cross([(1,2,3)],[(4,-1,2)]), [(1,2,3)]) → 0      ;; cross product ⊥ both inputs
```

```
F1:=[(10, 5, 0)]; F2:=[(0, 10, 5)];degr:=angle(F1, F2)/deg→66.42182152179818
V_sns:=[(10); (0)]; ang:=pi/4;V_global:= rot2(ang) V_sns → [(7.071); (7.071)]
```

$$\begin{cases} 2x - 3y = -4 \\ 3x - 2y = -1 \end{cases} \Rightarrow \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}$$

```
solve_lin([(2, -3);(3, -2)],[(-4);(-1)])→[(1); (2)]
```

Strings

You can enter a string, assign a string value to a variable, and perform string concatenation.

```
S1:="Hello,";S2:="World";S1+S2 → 'Hello, World!'
```

Constants

- **pi:** 3.14159265358979323846
- **e:** 2.71828182845904523536
- **phi:** 1.61803398874989484820 (Golden ratio)

Physical Constants (CODATA 2018)

Fundamental:

- **c0:** Speed of light in vacuum (299792458 m/s)
- **hp:** Planck constant (6.62607015e-34 J·s)
- **hb:** Reduced Planck constant $\hbar$ (1.054571817e-34 J·s)
- **gn:** Gravitational constant (6.67430e-11 m³/(kg·s²))
- **na:** Avogadro constant (6.02214076e23 mol⁻¹)
- **kb:** Boltzmann constant (1.380649e-23 J/K)
- **rg:** Universal gas constant (8.314462618 J/(mol·K))

Electromagnetic:

- **e0:** Electric constant (8.8541878128e-12 F/m)
- **u0:** Magnetic constant (1.25663706212e-6 H/m)
- **z0:** Impedance of vacuum (376.730313668 Ω)

Particle:

- **qe:** Elementary charge (1.602176634e-19 C)
- **me:** Electron mass (9.1093837015e-31 kg)
- **mp:** Proton mass (1.67262192369e-27 kg)
- **mn:** Neutron mass (1.67492749804e-27 kg)
- **rel:** Classical electron radius (2.8179403262e-15 m)
- **a0:** Bohr radius (5.29177210903e-11 m)

Astronomical:

- **au:** Astronomical unit (1.495978707e11 m)
- **ly:** Light year (9.4607304725808e15 m)
- **pc:** Parsec (3.0856775814914e16 m)

Additional:

- **ry:** Rydberg constant (10973731.568160 m⁻¹)
- **sb:** Stefan-Boltzmann constant (5.670374419e-8 W/(m²·K⁴))

Integer Limits:

- **max32, maxint:** Maximum signed 32-bit (2147483647)
- **maxu32, maxuint:** Maximum unsigned 32-bit (4294967295)

- **max64, maxlong**: Maximum signed 64-bit
- **maxu64, maxulong**: Maximum unsigned 64-bit

System:

- **version**: Calculator version
- **timezone**: System timezone offset (hours)
- **daylight**: Daylight saving time flag
- **tz**: Current timezone with DST

User Constants Files

Place these files in the same directory as the calculator executable to automatically load custom constants, variables, and user-defined functions at startup:

- **consts.txt** — loaded at startup, **overwritten** when a new version is installed. Use for built-in and shared definitions.
- **user.txt** — loaded at startup, **never overwritten** by installer. Use for personal constants and functions that should survive updates.

Both files support the same syntax: `const(...)`, `var(...)`, and function definitions `{name(args) expression}`. All predefined constants are available inside user-defined functions loaded from these files.

Output Formats

- Scientific
- Normalized
- Fraction
- Computing (uses KiB for binary multiples; KB is also accepted as input)
- Integer
- Unsigned
- Hexadecimal
- Octal
- Binary (configurable width)
- Character
- Wide Character
- Date/Time (supports :w weeks input format)
- Unix Time
- Degrees (supports gon and turns in addition to degrees/minutes/seconds)
- Temperature in Fahrenheit (75F format for input/output)
- String
- Inch

Engineering / Scientific Suffixes

Standard SI suffixes are supported for input and output. Additional high-order postfixes **Q** (1E30), **R** (1E27) and their lowercase counterparts **q** (1E-30), **r** (1E-27) are also supported.

For complex numbers, suffixes apply independently to both the real and imaginary parts in output:

```
polar(10k, 30`20'40") → 8.63k+5.052ki
```

Here k is applied separately to the real part (8.63k) and the imaginary part (5.052k), followed by i.

In engineering and normalized formats, the suffix order is based on the **modulus**. If the real or imaginary part differs from the modulus by three or more orders of magnitude, it is considered negligible and displayed as zero.

Usage

Note: This README covers the main features, but for a complete reference — including all functions, constants, formats, and options — consult the built-in help. In the GUI version press **F1**, in the CLI version run `ccalc "help(0)"` for an overview and `ccalc "help(n)"` for specific topics. The help is concise and sometimes shows only an example, but covers everything.

1. Type mathematical expressions in the input field
2. Results are calculated automatically as you type
3. Pressing enter places the current value of the input line in the history (if it is not already there), and in the input line - the result of the calculation as a real or complex number, or a matrix (this does not apply to string operations).
4. Use the history dropdown to recall previous calculations
5. Copy results with Ctrl+C or paste expressions with Ctrl+V
6. Access format options and binary width settings via the Calc menu or local menu if the output panel

Example Expressions

$2 + 3 * 4$

$\sin(\pi/2)$

$\sqrt{16} + \log(100)$

$2^3 * e$

$(5 + 3) / (2 - 1)$

Resonant frequency and wave resistance:

$L:=130\mu$; $C:=2.2n$; $f:=1/(2*\pi*\sqrt{L*C})$; $Rw:=\sqrt{L/C}$; `prn("f:%SHz, Rw:%SOhm", f, Rw);;`Resonant circuit

Result: f:297.6kHz, Rw:243.10hm

With Implicit Multiplication enabled:

$2\sin(\pi/2)$ # Same as $2 * \sin(\pi/2) = 2$

$3(4+5)$ # Same as $3 * (4+5) = 27$

$(1+2)(3+4)$ # Same as $(1+2) * (3+4) = 21$

2π # Same as $2 * \pi \approx 6.28$ (uppercase π to avoid pico suffix)

$3e$ # Same as $3 * e \approx 8.15$ (with uppercase E is $3e+18$, 3 exa)

Implicit Multiplication

When **Implicit Multiplication** is enabled (via Calc menu), you can omit the * operator in these common cases:

1. **Number before function:** $2\sin(x) \rightarrow 2 * \sin(x)$
2. **Number before parenthesis:** $3(4+5) \rightarrow 3 * (4+5)$
3. **Parenthesis after parenthesis:** $(1+2)(3+4) \rightarrow (1+2) * (3+4)$
4. **Number before variable/constant:** $2PI \rightarrow 2 * PI$ (uppercase recommended)
5. **Space instead of *:** $2\ 3 \rightarrow 2*3$

Important notes about scientific suffixes and imaginary unit:

- This feature is **disabled by default** — enable it via **Calc → Implicit multiplication** menu.
- **Scientific suffixes have highest priority:** Single-letter suffixes (k, M, G, m, u, n, **p**, f, a, etc.) are recognized first if followed by space, operator, or end of expression.
 - $3k \rightarrow 3 \times 10^3 = 3000$ (kilo)
 - $3p \rightarrow 3 \times 10^{-12} = 3e-12$ (pico)
 - $3p+5 \rightarrow 3 \times 10^{-12} + 5$ (pico suffix applies)
- **Lowercase i and j are reserved for imaginary unit:** They are recognized **after** scientific suffixes.
 - $5i \rightarrow 0+5i$ (imaginary number, not $5 * i$ variable)
 - $5j \rightarrow 0+5j$ (alternative imaginary unit notation)
 - $3pi \rightarrow 0+3e-12i$ (interpreted as 3 pico + imaginary unit i)
- **Use uppercase for variables to avoid conflicts:**
 - $3PI \rightarrow 3 * PI \approx 9.42$ (implicit multiplication with PI constant)
 - $3pI \rightarrow 3 * pI$ (also works: p followed by uppercase I avoids pico suffix)
 - $5I \rightarrow 5 * I$ (uppercase I as variable, not imaginary unit)
 - $2e \rightarrow 2 * e \approx 5.44$ (uppercase E as constant, not exponent notation)
 - $2E \rightarrow 22e+18$ (exa)

Recommended naming convention: Use **UPPERCASE** for constants/variables to avoid conflicts with scientific suffixes and imaginary unit (e.g., PI, E, PHI, X, Y, Z).

Keyboard Shortcuts

- **Ctrl+N**: Clear input field
- **Ctrl+Shift++**: Increase window opacity
- **Ctrl+Shift+-**: Decrease window opacity
- **Ctrl++/-**: Change font size
- **Ctrl+C**: Copy result to clipboard
- **Ctrl+V**: Paste from clipboard to expression
- **F1**: Show help contents
- **Esc**: Close help window / minimize main window (if ESC minimized option is enabled)
- **Right-click on output field**: Context menu with Copy and Format submenu — allows quick format changes even when the main menu is hidden (menu(0) mode)

Menu Options

Calc

- **Pas style / C style**: Toggle between Pascal-like syntax (use ^ for power, := for assignment) and C-like syntax
- **Case sensitive**: Toggle case sensitivity for variables/functions
- **Forced float**: Force all results to floating-point format
- **Implicit multiplication**: Allow omitting * operator (e.g., $2\sin(x)$, 3π)
- **ESC minimized**: Minimize window on ESC key
- **Always on top**: Keep calculator window on top of other windows
- **Opacity**: Adjust window transparency
- **Format submenu**: Select output format
- **Binary width submenu**: Select binary display width (8, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64 bits)
- **View variables**: Open variables dialog
- **Exit**: Close application

Build Requirements

- Visual Studio 2019 or later
- Windows SDK 10.0 or later
- C++17 standard
- BCB6 (Borland C++ Builder 6) compilation option is also available for the calculator engine

Building GUI Version (WinApiCalc)

1. Open `WinApiCalc.sln` in Visual Studio
2. Select configuration (Debug/Release) and platform (x86/x64)
3. Build solution (F7)
4. Executable will be in `x64/Release/fcalc.exe` or similar

Building CLI Version (ccalc)

1. Open `ccalc.vcxproj` in Visual Studio
2. Select configuration and platform
3. Build project
4. Executable will be in configured output directory

Both projects share the same calculation engine (`scalc.cpp`, `sfmts.cpp`, `sfunc.cpp`).

Dependencies

- `comctl32.lib` (Windows Common Controls)
- `htmlhelp.lib` (CHM help support)

Architecture

The application uses a clean separation of concerns:

- **Common calculation engine** (shared by both GUI and CLI):
 - **scalc.cpp/h**: Mathematical expression parser and evaluator
 - **sfmts.cpp/h**: Number format conversion and output
 - **sfunc.cpp/h**: Mathematical functions implementation
- **GUI version** (WinApiCalc):
 - **WinApiCalc.cpp/h**: Main application window and UI management
 - **Resources**: Menus, dialogs, and accelerators
- **CLI version** (ccalc):
 - **ccalc.cpp/h**: Command-line interface and argument parsing
 - **help.cpp**: Built-in help system

Project Structure

```
APICalc/
├── scalc.cpp/h      # Calculation engine (shared)
├── sfmts.cpp/h      # Format handling (shared)
├── sfunc.cpp/h      # Math functions (shared)
├── WinApiCalc.cpp/h # GUI application
├── WinApiCalc.rc     # GUI resources
├── consts.txt        # Built-in user constants and functions (overwritten on update)
├── user.txt          # Personal user constants and functions (never overwritten)
├── ccalc/            # CLI version
│   ├── ccalc.cpp/h  # CLI main
│   ├── help.cpp     # Help system
│   └── ccalc.cfg     # Configuration file
├── fcalc.chm         # Help file
└── README.md        # This file
```

Help File Integration

Place your CHM help file as `fcalc.chm` in the same directory as the executable to enable F1 help functionality.

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